

06 - FIRE Engine (Filing Information Returns Electronically)

Overview

The FIRE Engine manages electronic transmission of information returns (1099-series, W-2G, and 5498-series) to the IRS FIRE system via SFTP, aligned to IRS Publication 1220 specifications.

Supported Information Returns

Form	Description	Deadline
1099-NEC	Nonemployee Compensation	Jan 31
1099-MISC	Miscellaneous Income	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
1099-INT	Interest Income	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
1099-DIV	Dividends	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
1099-R	Retirement Distributions	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
1099-K	Payment Card Transactions	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
1099-G	Government Payments	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
1099-S	Real Estate Proceeds	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
W-2G	Gambling Winnings	Feb 28 / Mar 31 (e-file)
5498	IRA Contribution Info	May 31
5498-SA	HSA Contribution Info	May 31

Note: 10 or more information returns require mandatory e-filing (effective tax year 2024).

FIRE SFTP Connection

```
fire_sftp:
  host: "fire.irs.gov"
  port: 22
  username: "[TCC-linked FIRE account for EFIN 748335]"
  auth_method: "password"
  remote_upload_path: "/upload"
  remote_status_path: "/status"
```

```
connection_timeout_seconds: 30
tcc: "[Your Transmitter Control Code]"
```

File Structure per Publication 1220

T Record - Transmitter Record (1 per file)
 A Record - Payer Record (1 per payer)
 B Records - Payee Records (1 per payee)
 C Record - End of Payer Record
 F Record - End of Transmitter Record

Transmission Process

```
[Generate Information Return Data]
-> [Format per Publication 1220]
-> [File Name: {TCC}{Year}{Sequence}.txt]
-> [Duplicate Detection Check]
-> [SFTP Upload to /upload]
-> [Poll /status for FIRE status file]
-> [Parse status: Good/Bad/Mixed]
-> [Correct and resubmit bad records]
```

FIRE Status Codes

Status	Meaning	Action
Good	All records accepted	Archive file
Bad	All records rejected	Correct entire file and resubmit
Mixed	Partial acceptance	Submit replacement file for bad records
Not yet processed	FIRE queue	Poll again in 2 hours

Seasonal Throttle Policy

Period	Max Files/Hour	Reason
Jan 1 - Mar 31	5	IRS peak season
Apr 1 - Dec 31	20	Standard

Configuration

```
fire_engine:
  tcc: "[Transmitter Control Code]"
  efin: "748335"
  test_mode: false
```

```
duplicate_detection: true
file_name_pattern: "{TCC}{year}{seq:04d}.txt"
seasonal_throttle:
  jan_mar: 5
  apr_dec: 20
status_poll_interval_minutes: 120
archive_path: "/archives/fire/{year}/"
```